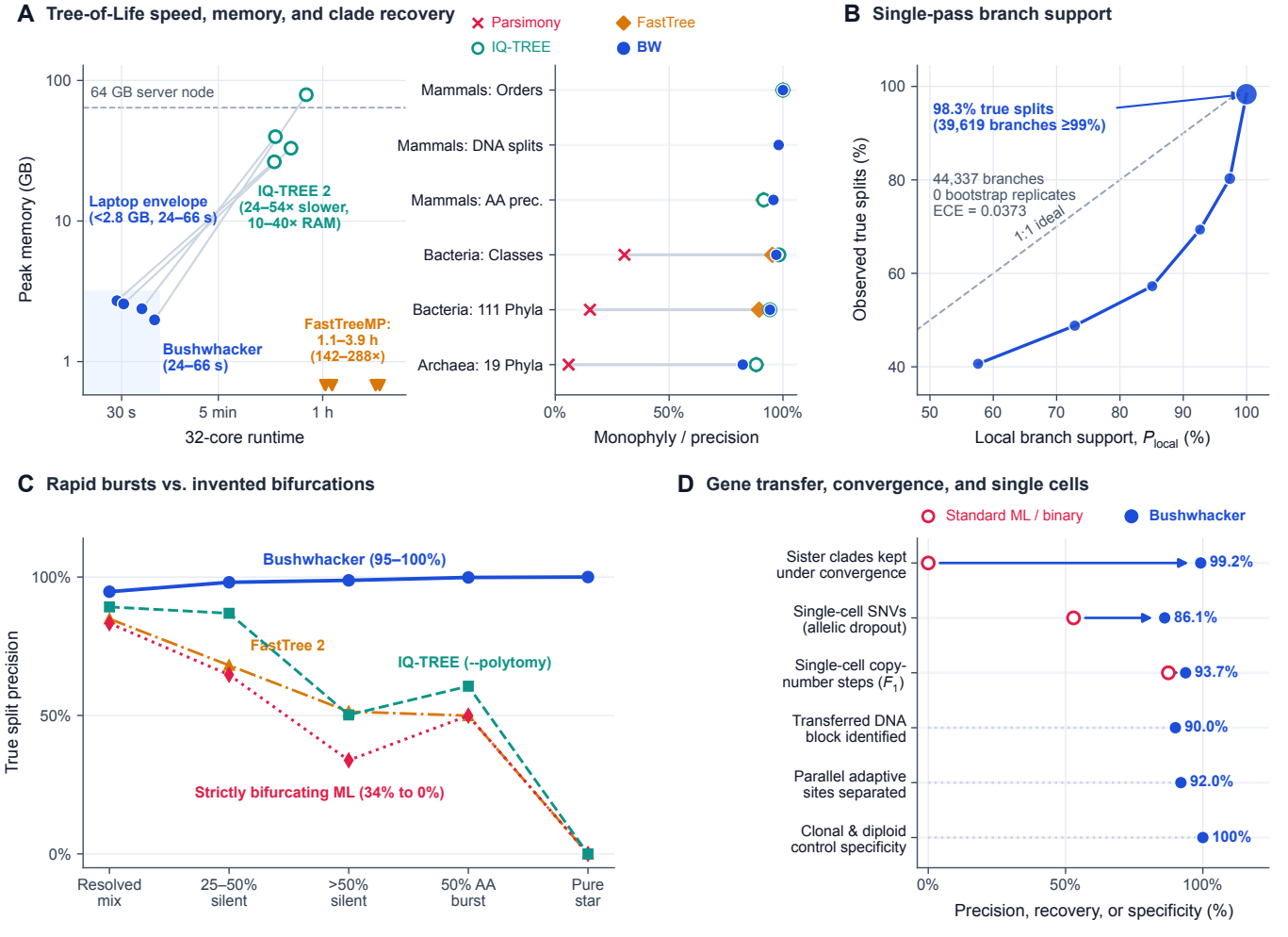

A Tree-of-Life speed, memory, and clade recovery
Parsimony
FastTree
IQ-TREE
BW
64 GB server node
Peak memory (GB)
100
10
1
Laptop envelope
(<2.8 GB, 24–66 s)
IQ-TREE 2
(24–54× slower,
10–40× RAM)
Bushwhacker
(24–66 s)
FastTreeMP:
1.1–3.9 h
(142–288×)
30 s
5 min
1 h
32-core runtime
Mammals: Orders
Mammals: DNA splits
Mammals: AA prec.
Bacteria: Classes
Bacteria: 111 Phyla
Archaea: 19 Phyla
0%
50%
100%
Monophyly / precision
B Single-pass branch support
Observed true splits (%)
100
80
60
40
98.3% true splits
(39,619 branches ≥99%)
44,337 branches
0 bootstrap replicates
ECE = 0.0373
1:1 ideal
50
60
70
80
90
100
Local branch support, P_{local} (%)
C Rapid bursts vs. invented bifurcations
Bushwhacker (95–100%)
FastTree 2
IQ-TREE (--polytomy)
Strictly bifurcating ML (34% to 0%)
True split precision
100%
50%
0%
Resolved
mix
25–50%
silent
>50%
silent
50% AA
burst
Pure
star
D Gene transfer, convergence, and single cells
Standard ML / binary
Bushwhacker
Sister clades kept
under convergence
99.2%
Single-cell SNVs
(allelic dropout)
86.1%
Single-cell copy-
number steps (F_1)
93.7%
Transferred DNA
block identified
90.0%
Parallel adaptive
sites separated
92.0%
Clonal & diploid
control specificity
100%
0%
50%
100%
Precision, recovery, or specificity (%)